ProTech 2.0 Space-Based Environmental Monitoring (SBEM) Domain IDIQ
DRAFT RFP 1305M426R0011
J.4 Questions & Answers Form

#	Reference	Page No.	Question/Comment	NOAA Response
1	N/A	N/A	Could you kindly confirm whether this initiative represents a new undertaking, or is there an incumbent currently delivering these services? If an incumbent exists, may we request the relevant details of their contract, including the contract number?	This initiative represents a new undertaking.
2	Draft RFP, Section A	2	Will the Government consider responding direct to proprietary specific questions with appropriate markings? - Rationale: Provides additional clarity in developing a potential proposal response.	No, this is not authorized.
3	N/A	N/A	Does NOAA intend to cover coastal topography bathymetry change products, specifically shoreline erosion and vertical land motion subsidence?	At this time, no. For the initial IDIQ award, NOAA is only considering capabilities that meet the criteria in one or more of the seven Functional Categories listed in the draft SBEM IDIQ SOW. In the future, NOAA may consider other additional SBEM capabilities.
4	N/A	N/A	Does the government request vendors to only submit their questions using DRAFT J.4 - Questions & Answers Form.xlsx?	NOAA requests that vendors submit their questions using Attachment J.4. However, for the purposes of this draft RFP, using the template is not required.
5	N/A	N/A	Is the next engagement point the Industry Day scheduled for April 9?	At this time, yes, the next engagement point is the Industry Day scheduled for April 9.
6	N/A	N/A	Regarding the note that this draft RFP is intended for information and planning purposes, and to allow industry to assess feasibility and provide input, would you recommend sharing feedback during Industry Day, or is there a preferred channel for submitting comments?	Recommend that feedback is submitted via email to the POCs listed in the Draft RFP Notice by 1PM EDT, March 24, 2026.
7	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026 .pdf	2	In Section C.1, the SOW states that 'NOAA may consider additional SBEM data types for technologies that may, within the IDIQ timeframe, enhance NOAAs mission needs.' Could NOAA clarify if sounding rockets or similar suborbital systems (e.g., providing in-situ ionospheric and upper-atmospheric measurements for satellite data calibration) would qualify as 'additional SBEM data types'? If so, what evaluation criteria would apply to such non-orbital technologies?	No, NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude).
8	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026 .pdf	10	For Functional Categories like GNSS-RO and GNSS-R (e.g., pricing tiers based on daily occultations or reflections), how might NOAA adapt the structures for hybrid or complementary data sources, such as those from sounding rockets that provide calibration 'truth data' for satellite products? For example, could per-flight or per-dataset pricing be incorporated for technologies high cadence offerings?	NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude). There are no plans to incorporate hybrid or complimentary data sources; however, NOAA does support contractors subcontracting for such if needed.
9	DRAFT J.2 - IDIQ Price Schedule	1	In the commercial marketplace, data from sounding rockets or similar systems (e.g., for atmospheric profiling) is often priced per mission or subscription-based Data-as-a-Service (DaaS). What suggestions does NOAA have for integrating such models into Attachment J.2 to optimize for cost-effectiveness and innovation?	NOAA NESDIS currently does not find the mission-based or subscription-based business model appropriate. The IDIQ contracting vehicle was determined best suited due to the unknown amount of data required for each Task Order.
10	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026 .pdf	2	Attachment J.1 (SOW) and J.2 reference data license options (e.g., distribution rights to U.S. government agencies). For additional data types like in-situ ionospheric measurements from sounding rockets, could NOAA provide guidance on preferred licensing models that allow dual-use (commercial + government) while ensuring compliance with FAR and cybersecurity standards (e.g., NIST SP 800-171)?	For space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude), NOAA may consider alternative licensing models, per the SBEM IDIQ SoW section C.3.7. DATA RIGHTS.
11	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026 .pdf	2	How does NOAA envision integrating non-satellite data (e.g., GNSS-RO profiles from sounding rockets) into existing workflows, such as NESDIS models for weather forecasting or space weather? Would standards like netCDF/HDF5 and MIL-STD-1553 interfaces suffice for near-real-time delivery?	NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude).
12	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026. pdf	2	In Section C.1, NOAA states it may consider additional SBEM data types for technologies that may, within the IDIQ timeframe, enhance NOAAs mission needs. Could sounding rockets or similar suborbital systems providing high-resolution in-situ measurements of electron density, ion composition, neutral density, winds, temperature, and electric fields in the E-region (~90-150 km) qualify as such additional data types for calibration and validation of GNSS-RO and other satellite products?	No, NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude).
13	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026. pdf	10	Section C.9 defines the Thermospheric Neutral Density Functional Category. Would NOAA be interested in complementary in-situ neutral density, composition, temperature, and wind profiles from sounding rockets in the lower thermosphere (~90-120 km), an altitude range that is challenging for orbital platforms but critical for model validation and satellite drag prediction?	No, NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude).
14	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026. pdf	3	Section C.2 emphasizes complementary technologies for space weather prediction and atmospheric profiling. For sounding rocket payloads carrying simultaneous sensors (e.g., Langmuir/Impedance Probes for electron density/temperature, Retarding Potential Analyzers for ion properties, electric field probes, and neutral wind sensors), how would NOAA envision using these multi-parameter in-situ datasets as truth data to validate or improve GNSS-RO, Microwave Sounder, or Active Sensor products?	NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude).
15	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026. pdf	10	In Section C.1 and C.11 (Additional SBEM Data), NOAA opens the door to novel space-based capabilities. What evaluation criteria or pilot-task-order structure would NOAA apply to sounding-rocket-derived in-situ ionospheric and thermospheric datasets intended to fill observational gaps between orbital satellite passes at mid-latitudes?	NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude). Therefore, no evaluation criteria exists.
16	DRAFT J.2 - IDIQ Price Schedule	1	Commercial sounding-rocket missions for ionospheric/thermospheric in-situ data are typically priced on a per-launch or annual multi-launch subscription (DaaS) basis. For high-frequency campaigns (e.g., 50+ events/year) providing calibration truth data for GNSS-RO and Thermospheric Neutral Density products, what optimizations or additional pricing tiers would NOAA find most useful in Attachment J.2?	NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude). However, NOAA does support contractors subcontracting for calibration truth data if needed.
17	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026. pdf	3	For integration of sounding-rocket in-situ data (e.g., electron/ion density profiles and plasma irregularities from Langmuir probes + RPA) into NESDIS workflows, would standards such as netCDF/HDF5, full ISO 19115 metadata, and near-real-time or post-flight delivery (per C.3.2) suffice for use in space-weather forecasting and model assimilation?	NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude). Therefore, these standards have not been assessed for other than space-based assets.

18	DRAFT J.1 - SBEM IDIQ SOW v4 March6_2026.pdf	2	Section C.2 highlights space weather applications and the value of complementary data sources. Given the scarcity of high-cadence mid-latitude in-situ measurements in the E-region and lower thermosphere, could frequent sounding-rocket campaigns (with co-aligned sensors such as Langmuir probes, electric field probes, neutral mass spectrometers, and wind sensors) meaningfully augment NOAAs operational pipeline for ionospheric scintillation, radio propagation, and numerical weather prediction?	It is currently unknown to what extent frequent sounding-rocket campaigns would augment NOAA's operational pipeline as NOAA NESDIS is only considering space-based assets either operating or planned to operate on-orbit in space (defined as 100 km or higher in altitude).
19	N/A	N/A	Can we get on the IDIQ if there are plans to onramp a capability within the PoP if the technical capability is currently still in development?	Onramping will be continuous. You may submit a proposal at any time. Please review sections L&M of the solicitation for futher detail.
20	L.6.1 Format	63	Subject: Clarification on Technical Volume II Page Limit Application The solicitation indicates that Technical Volume II is limited to eight (8) pages per proposed Functional Category. At the same time, offerors are instructed to describe their ability to meet the requirements outlined in the General Sections of SOW Section C.3, which apply to all offerors regardless of Functional Category. Could the Government please clarify whether responses addressing the General Section requirements in SOW Section C.3 are expected to be included within the eight-page limit allocated per Functional Category, or if they may be addressed separately from those page limitations?	Section C.3. responses should be included in each functional category proposal, as part of that 8-page limit for the Functional Category.
21	RFP Section I.2 / Clause 1330-52.208-70	27	Subject: Clarification on AbilityOne Subcontracting Requirements (RFP Section I.2 / Clause 1330-52.208-70) The current draft of Clause 1330-52.208-70 identifies that a subcontracting plan is required and specifically mandates the inclusion of AbilityOne as a separate goal. Given the highly specialized and technical nature of space-based environmental monitoring (SBEM) and satellite technologies, requiring specific vendor categories at this stage can be overly restrictive for prime contractors who must ensure mission-critical technical precision. Would the Government consider selecting the alternative version of this clause which states: "A subcontracting plan is not required. The contractor should consider subcontracting with AbilityOne nonprofit organizations to the maximum extent practicable and allowable consistent with other statutory and regulatory requirements applicable to the acquisition"? This change would allow prime contractors the necessary flexibility to prioritize the rigorous technical requirements of the SOW while still encouraging the use of small business - specifically AbilityOne organizations - where feasible and appropriate	This is a mandatory procedure whether or not a subcontracting plan is required. Please note there are no mandatory contractual requirements to subcontract with AbilityOne. The Government encourages the prime contractor to provide subcontracting opportunities to AbilityOne contractors. The Government will review the Offeror's proposed plan for using AbilityOne contractors and will consider the extent to which qualified AbilityOne contractors are proposed to perform aspects of the requirement, including work associated with the functional requirements of the SOW. AbilityOne will not be scored for evaluation purposes.
22	Attachment J.2	N/A	Subject: Clarification on Attachment J.2 Price Schedule Scenarios and Constellation Scaling Regarding Attachment J.2, specifically the pricing worksheets for Functional Categories such as Microwave Sounders (FC 3), the "Scenarios" for Total Evaluated Price (TEP) only provide for a maximum of 10 satellites. If an offeror plans to operate a constellation significantly exceeding this number to provide higher revisit rates and data density, how should this additional capacity be reflected? Does the Government prefer that vendors add additional rows to the spreadsheet to provide pricing for larger constellation scales? Alternatively, should vendors only provide pricing for the exact quantities/scenarios currently listed in the template? If the latter, will the Government allow for the incorporation of pricing for higher satellite counts at the task order level, or should the price for "10 satellites" be considered a ceiling for all larger quantities?	There is no ceiling of quantities. If a vendor can provide more data than the scenarios listed, the provider should add additional rows to accommodate their proposed amounts, respectively with their current structure and plans. However, in order for the government to evaluate fair and reasonable pricing between companies, the sum of only the rows initially in the excel sheet will be utilized in the TEP.
23	Attachment J.2	N/A	Subject: Clarification on Attachment J.2 TEP Scenarios and License Option 4 While License Option 4 is defined in the Data License Descriptions, it is not currently included as selectable or evaluated options within the TEP Pricing Schedule scenarios for the Base or Option periods. Will the Government consider adding License 4 and 4A (with a 24-hour embargo)—to the TEP evaluation scenarios? Including these options provides a formal mechanism for the Government to evaluate the significant cost-savings associated with a US. Gov only licensing. From a cost perspective, License 4/4A allows vendors to offer highly attractive, discounted pricing because it preserves the commercial value of real-time data while providing the US Gov Weather Enterprise with a high-volume, low-cost solution for non-latency-sensitive applications	Yes, license 4 and 4A will be added as requested to each Functional Category.
24	Attachment J.2	N/A	Similar to question 4 above, will the government consider also adding a License option 5 and 5A which will restrict data use to a single Federal Government Agency… eg. U.S. Department of Commerce. This will allow vendors to offer even more aggressive discounts to NOAA	NOAA NESDIS does not intend to utilize this licence option for the SBEM IDIQ.
25	Attachment J.1	Pg 2	Subject: Clarification on SOW Section C.3 General Requirements – Data Archiving and Storage Rights The SOW states that "All data and products will be archived by NOAA" and that the Government may seek "value-added or derived products". Currently, the pricing scenarios in Attachment J.2 assume a standard delivery and archive model without specified duration limits. Will the Government consider adding pricing scenarios or license options that allow for tiered pricing based on the duration of data storage and archival rights (e.g., 5-year archive, 10-year archive, vs. perpetual)? Also add pricing scenarios for "value-added or derived products"? In the commercial satellite industry, the cost of data is also significantly impacted by the length of the storage as well as adding value to the raw data products. By allowing vendors to offer discounts for shorter-term storage rights or applying markups for permanent archival rights, the Government can more effectively optimize its budget and capture substantial cost savings for data that may have a limited operational shelf-life. Similarly for raw vs. value added data products.	The pricing structure is a ceiling cost will be used for all data levels, including derived products. Please price accordingly. NOAA does not intend to update the pricing structure for duration of data storage as NOAA stores data through NCEI.
26	Attachment J.1	Pg 6	Subject: Clarification on SOW Section C.3.6 Security Requirements Can NOAA clarify whether compliance with NIST SP 800-53 High baseline (or equivalent) is required at time of award, or whether offerors may propose a phased approach demonstrating alignment at award with a defined timeline to achieve full compliance?	Compliance with security and privacy control standards are expected at the time data is delivered.
27	Attachment J.1	Pg 6	Subject: Clarification on SOW Section C.3.6 Security Requirements Can NOAA clarify whether security compliance requirements (e.g., alignment to NIST SP 800-53 High) are expected to apply to the entirety of an offeror's data collection and processing architecture, or specifically to the systems and environments used to deliver data into NOAA's operational ingest interfaces (e.g., NCCF)?"	NIST SP 800-53 applies not to the entirety of an offeror's data collection and processing architecture, but to the systems and environments that process, store, transmit, or otherwise support federal information or services. At a minimum, this includes the systems used to deliver data into NOAA's operational ingest interfaces (e.g., NCCF) and any intermediate staging, processing, or transmission components. The scope may also extend to upstream elements of the architecture where they materially affect the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of the data provided to NOAA.
28	Section C.2 Scope	1	Please confirm that the SBEM IDIQ is open to commercial systems operating in any orbital regime, including architectures that differ from heritage LEO systems referenced in the draft (e.g., systems with continuous coverage or non traditional constellation designs).	Correct. The SBEM IDIQ is open to any orbit regime and does not delineate orbit.
29	Section C.7.3.2.1 Observation Capability	38-39	Table 2 is based on legacy sensors and spectral ranges. Will NOAA clarify that these spectral references are guidance only, and that systems with alternative or expanded spectral capabilities (including different band placements or additional channels) remain eligible if they meet the stated mission objectives and product performance needs?	Yes, Table 2 is intended as guidance based on legacy sensors. Systems with alternative or expanded spectral capabilities—including different band placements or additional channels—are still eligible, provided they meet the stated mission objectives and product performance requirements.
30	Section C.3.2 Delivery Requirements	3	- For systems capable of continuous or near continuous data delivery, how does NOAA intend to interpret latency and cadence requirements in future Task Orders (e.g., should providers deliver at native instrument cadence, or at a cadence specified by NOAA for operational ingest and processing)?	NOAA will specify details on the latency required in Pilot and Operational TOs. However, NOAA only typically requires latency that is sufficient enough to meet operational ingest and processing.

31	Section C.3.2 & Section C.7.3.2	2–4, 38	Will NOAA allow disaggregated or multi platform architectures (e.g., separate instruments or platforms contributing to a single capability area) to collectively meet Task Order requirements, provided that end to end performance, coverage, and data quality objectives are satisfied?	Yes, disaggregated or multi-platform architectures are acceptable, provided they collectively meet the Task Order requirements as specified in the IDIQ and subsequent Task Order SOWs.
32	Section C (General Requirements)	1–8	Will NOAA provide evaluation criteria or additional guidance for novel or non heritage architectures whose performance characteristics differ from legacy systems (e.g., different spectral sets, coverage patterns, or data volumes), to ensure such offerings are evaluated on mission value rather than strict similarity to heritage systems?	Yes, NOAA will provide further clarification for novel or non-heritage systems during a Pilot Task Order RFP.
33	RFP Section L.8.2.1(f)	65	Under NAICS 518210, a small business may qualify at the time of initial award but exceed the $40M size standard during the 10-year (including options) period of performance. Can the Government clarify the "graduation" process? Specifically, if a contractor's status changes to "other-than-small," will they remain eligible for task orders, and at what point is a Small Business Subcontracting Plan required for a previously self-performing entity?	Updated in RFP.
34	RFP Section I (FAR 52.227-14)	35-37	Clause 52.227-14 grants the Government "unlimited rights" in data "first produced" in contract performance. Can the Government confirm that raw commercial data provided to NOAA is considered a "service deliverable" rather than "first produced" data, to ensure the contractor's commercial market is protected?	Data created under contract performance is considered "first produced".
35	SOW Section C.3.7	7-8	Section C.3.7 states the Contractor assigns NOAA ownership and copyright of all contract deliverables, including raw data. This appears to contradict the data-sharing "Options" (1, 2, 3) which imply a licensed access model. Can the Government clarify if it requires outright ownership of the raw data or a perpetual license to use and distribute it based on the selected Task Order option?	We have provided License Data Rights Options in lieu of a Copyright and omitted the copyright clause from the RFP and SOW.
36	SOW Section C.7.3.2.3	48	Commercial multispectral sensors now regularly achieve resolutions significantly better than 750 m. To support the detection of small, early-stage fires, would the Government consider a horizontal spatial resolution threshold of 100 m–200 m?	NOAA concurs that the requirements for the detection of small, early-stage fires would be at considerably higher resolution than the stated 750m. However, the 750m value is a threshold value intended to cover a wide range of potential applications in the IDIQ. Individual Task Orders, such as one for the detection of early-stage fires, will have specific spatial resolution threshold requirements that can be higher than that value (i.e. the 100-200m mentioned).
37	SOW Section C.2	2	Does the Government intend to provide a streamlined "bridge" or transition mechanism for successful Pilots to move into Operational Deliveries without a new competitive solicitation?	NOAA NESDIS has a Transition to Operations (T2O) process to provide a mechanism to move successful pilots to sustained operational purchasing. While operational purchases will be from Offeror datasets that have completed the T2O process, solicitations may still need to be competitive due to U.S. Government procurement requirements.
38	SOW Section C.5.4	23-24	Would the Government consider reducing the GNSS-R threshold data volume to 100 tracks / day to account for the under-specified quality control metrics, which may vary or be more specifically defined in the Task Orders?	NOAA has reduced the threshold to 100 tracks/day to offer greater flexibility and account for QC metrics. Specific Task Orders may specify different data volumes.
39	SOW Section C.5.4	23	Would the Government be open to constraining the GNSS-R performance levels to L1 data characteristics (i.e. removing requirements such as accuracy/speed, which is a requirement on an L2 product that not is not directly controlled by all data providers)?	Yes, the GNSS-R performance levels for L1 data characteristics will be considered separately from L2 data characteristics. Specific Task Orders may request L1 data and/or L2 data which will have different requirements as described in detail in the Task Order.
40	SOW Section C.2 / Attachment J.2	5	The SOW notes that NOAA may seek "value-added or derived products". How does the Government intend for Offerors to account for the significant cost/effort delta between providing raw Level 0 data versus fully processed Level 2 geophysical products within the Attachment J.2 Price Schedule?	The pricing structure is a ceiling cost that will be used for all data levels, including derived products. Each Task Order will offer specifics on value-added or derived products requested, and Offerors will be able to provide a price breakdown narrative accounting for the processing premium over the base L0 and/or L1 data cost.
41	RFP Section B.3 / B.4	6	Will the Government consider adding separate CLINs or line items in Attachment J.2 for different data processing levels (e.g., Level 0, Level 1B, Level 2) for each Functional Category?	The pricing structure is a ceiling cost that will be used for all data levels, including derived products. Each Task Order will offer specifics on value-added or derived products requested, and Offerors will be able to provide a price breakdown narrative accounting for the processing premium over the base L0 and/or L1 data cost.
42	J.2+-+IDIQ+Price+Schedule	FC 4 - MSI Base	Would the government be open to showing the calculation of km^2 Total Volume = AOI (sq km) × Frequency (per month) × Term (months)	The Contractor should enter the price per sq km as quantity independent of AOI. Pricing Sheet updated for clarity.
43	J.2+-+IDIQ+Price+Schedule	FC 4 - MSI Base	Including the disclaimer that pricing uses tiered marginal rates. Each rate applies only to the portion of volume within that tier — larger volumes unlock lower rates on incremental volume. With a minimum order of $100,000. Additional coverage area tiers with area's above 10 billion sq km requiring custom pricing.	The pricing tiers represent cumulative imaged area over the duration of the Task Order. For example, for a constellation providing daily global coverage, the entire surface area of the Earth is imaged 365 times per year and thus the km^2 coverage could be in the highest (billions) tier. Each pricing tier reflects the price per km^2 for a specific range of total area purchased. For example, if a Task Order was for 600,000 km^2 of MS data, then the ceiling price for the 500,000-1M tier will apply.
44	SoW Section C.7.3.2.1	38	Suggest making the Threshold requirement for wildfire imagery a minimum of 3 bands: one in SWIR, one in MWIR, and one in LWIR. The additional SWIR band is important for characterizing the hottest wildfires that do the most ecosystem damage.	NOAA concurs that the threshold requirements of a minimum of 3 bands would be beneficial for wildfire imagery. However, the stated requirements are intended to cover a wide range of potential applications in the IDIQ. Please note that C.7.3.2.1 references desired spectral bands as reference guidance based on legacy capabilities. Task Orders will include specific threshold requirements for required bands, and may also request data vendors to propose alternative or enhanced spectral configurations provided they meet the overall mission objectives and product performance requirements.

45	SoW Section C.7.3.2.1	38	In SoW Section C.7.3.2.1, the ideal system has a lot of bands, seemingly trying to replicate the multi-use systems NOAA currently flies. For each application of interest, only a subset of the ideal bands are actually required. Suggestion is to change the language to "Ideal systems may include bands in the following ranges" or something to that effect.	As Table 2 provides overarching guidance, Contractors are required to meet one or more of the spectral ranges identified for each capability area. While an ideal system may include bands across the VNIR, SWIR, MWIR, and LWIR ranges, only a subset of these bands is necessary for any specific application, as also noted in item 4 of C.7.3.2.1.
46	SoW Section C7.3.2.2	39	Table 3 suggestions to clarify multispectral imagery performance requirements: -Suggestion 1: State a spatial resolution threshold requirement of 1km, objective of 500m, across the entire swath. -Suggestion 2: Spectral bands - recommend specifying the ideal bands as Objective requirements. -Suggestion 3: Add a latency requirement (e.g. Threshold 3 hours, Objective 1 hour). -Suggestion 4: Add a band-to-band registration requirement with Threshold of 500m, Objective of native pixel resolution. -Suggestion 5: Add an Objective requirement for global coverage. If the Government is not willing to modify Table 3, here are some other suggestions or points to clarify in SoW: -Spatial resolution requirement - the IFOV requirement "shall not differ by more than 2x between the edge of the scan and nadir" is not clear. This is simply set by the max nadir angle of the scan; suggest this requirement is removed. -Spectral response: This is stated as "ensure sensor relative spectral responses are well-calibrated and calibrated." This is not well defined. It's not clear what it means to be well characterized and calibrated. -Radiometric Calibration: As stated, this is not a requirement. It's not clear that existing systems should be made to match legacy systems as this would have to be a design requirement when building the instrument. Second, the radiometric calibration accuracy requirement is use-case dependent. Recommend not requiring an overall requirement for this. Suggest requiring that the radiometric calibration accuracy is characterized and reported.	Low-light imagery is derived from the day-night band (DNB) sensor. Its proven value, particularly over Alaska, has led NESDIS to designate it as mission-critical. While low-light imagery has distinct observational requirements, it remains an integral component of the overall mission alongside weather imagery.
47	SoW Section C7.3.2.2	40	Table 3 suggestions to clarify multispectral imagery performance requirements: -Suggestion 1: State a spatial resolution threshold requirement of 1km, objective of 500m, across the entire swath. -Suggestion 2: Spectral bands - recommend specifying the ideal bands as Objective requirements. -Suggestion 3: Add a latency requirement (e.g. Threshold 3 hours, Objective 1 hour). -Suggestion 4: Add a band-to-band registration requirement with Threshold of 500m, Objective of native pixel resolution. -Suggestion 5: Add an Objective requirement for global coverage. If the Government is not willing to modify Table 3, here are some other suggestions or points to clarify in SoW: -Spatial resolution requirement - the IFOV requirement "shall not differ by more than 2x between the edge of the scan and nadir" is not clear. This is simply set by the max nadir angle of the scan; suggest this requirement is removed. -Spectral response: This is stated as "ensure sensor relative spectral responses are well-calibrated and calibrated." This is not well defined. It's not clear what it means to be well characterized and calibrated. -Radiometric Calibration: As stated, this is not a requirement. It's not clear that existing systems should be made to match legacy systems as this would have to be a design requirement when building the instrument. Second, the radiometric calibration accuracy requirement is use-case dependent. Recommend not requiring an overall requirement for this. Suggest requiring that the radiometric calibration accuracy is characterized and reported.	Spatial Resolution: Covered in Table 4. Spectral Bands: Guided by Table 2; intentionally flexible to allow vendor innovation. Latency: Addressed in Table 4 BBR: Covered by geolocation calibration that includes consistent spatial alignment across bands. Global Coverage: Covered in Table 4. Additional Clarifications: See the updated Table 3 with accompanying notes
48	SoW Section C.7.3.2.2	41	Table 4 suggestions for multispectral observation requirements: -Geolocation accuracy - The requested accuracy as written is better than a single pixel. That level of accuracy is not required for many applications. Suggest changing geolocation accuracy threshold requirement to 50% of Horizontal spatial resolution Requirement (i.e. 375m).	The geolocation accuracy aligns with legacy multispectral sensors. Requirements are 750 m for VIIRS-type M-Band and 375 m for I-Band at nadir, with VIS–NIR imager bands requiring 375 m or better for operationally usable data.
49	SoW Section C.7.3.2.3	42	Table 5 suggestions for Fire Imagery requirements: -Geolocation accuracy - The requested accuracy as written is better than a single pixel. That level of accuracy is not required for many fire imagery applications. Suggest changing geolocation accuracy threshold requirement to 50% of Horizontal spatial resolution Requirement (i.e. 375m). -Horizontal spatial resolution - Suggest changing the objective from 200m to 50m at nadir. -L1B Latency - Suggest changing threshold to 1h, objective to 15 minutes. -Fire Products: Suggest adding rows in the table for derived wildfire products such as fire detection, perimeters, and FRP. -Spectral Bands: Suggest adding spectral band requirements to the table with a threshold requirement of one SWIR, one MWIR, and one LWIR band. -Revist: Suggest adding a revisit requirement with no threshold, but an objective requirement to the table of <1h.	The threshold requirements are written to accommodate a wide range of possible Task Order applications, and specific Task Orders will have more restrictive threshold and objective requirements than those in the IDIQ. -Geolocation accuracy: The threshold and objective requirement for the geolocation accuracy is revised as follows. Threshold: 100% of Horizontal spatial resolution, Objective: 50% of Horizontal spatial resolution. -Horizontal spatial resolution at nadir: Objective can be reduced but for the general IDIQ we will revise to 100-200 m (considering that specific Task Orders may use 50m). -L1B data latency: This is reduced but not to that extent, considering that this is for the IDIQ and that specific Task Orders may be more restrictive. NOAA's preferred latency requirement for L1B data is: Threshold: 3 hours, Objective: 60 minutes -Fire Products: This suggestion will be more relevant to specific Task Orders. Vendors are welcome to provide options that include derived fire products, but it is not required. -Spectral Bands: Table 5 caption is revised to "MultiSpectral Fire Observational Requirements." - Revisit rate is not added to Table 5 but the following sentence is added to the "C.7.4. Delivery Requirements" section. "3. Requirements for constellation-level revisit/refresh rates will be specified in Task Order RFPs."
50	SoW Section C.7.3.2.3	42	Why is SoW Table 5 Fire Imagery specified as "VNIR"? Shouldn't this include the primary wildfire detection bands of MWIR, and the characterization and false-positive rejection bands of SWIR and LWIR? Suggest changing Table 5 to recognize that wildfire requires bands across the spectrum from visible through LWIR.	Table 5 caption is revised to be: "MultiSpectral Fire Observational Requirements."
51	SoW Section C.3.2	3	Can the Government clarify if the Areas of Interest (AOIs) and collection frequencies defined in a Task Order are intended to remain static for the duration of the performance period (meaning they won't change over the duration of a one year task order)?	Requirements shall not change during the period of performance of any Task Order unless specified in the Task Order or when an official modification is made.

52	SoW Section C.3.7	6	The following two data rights considerations for operational task orders are recommended to ensure competitive pricing and protect commercial viability: (1) limited license v. ownership: Grant NOAA a non-exclusive license for payload data deliverables (raw and processed data) for internal use and interagency sharing without transferring ownership and (2) time-bounded rights for distribution: transition NOAA's perpetual distribution rights to a time-restricted model tied to the period of performance. These proposed data rights changes will enable NOAA to acquire data at a significantly lower price than less restrictive data sharing models while still achieving mission objectives.	We have clarified the licensing terminology in the SOW. We provide Data Licensing Options and have omitted references to ownership in the copyright clause from the RFP and SOW. With regard to time-bounded licensing rights, we will consider the limitations versus benefits of this type of contract for future DaaS purchases.
53	Draft RFP, Section L.6.2.2	66	Page 66 of the Draft RFP states: "The Technical Capability Volume shall demonstrate the Offeror's ability to provide on-orbit operational capability." Does this mean the prime must be a satellite or spaceborne sensor operator, and cannot be a data integrator or data broker?	The Contractor must operate a sensor on-orbit that provides a capability that meets the requirements in one or more Functional Categories.
54	Draft J.2 IDIQ Price Schedule	n/a	The pricing template only has Data License Option and Supplies Quantity specifications. Do these mean this IDIQ is just intended for commercial data buy, and will not cover professional services with relevant labor categories?	The IDIQ is primarily intended for commercial data purchases.
55	Draft RFP, Section I	26-27	We are a small business under NAICS Codes 518210 and as such aren't required to submit a Small Business Subcontracting Plan under FAR 52 .219-9 but under NOAA Acquisition Manual 1330-52.208-70 SUBCONTRACTING WITH ABILITYONE NONPROFIT ORGANIZATIONS (DECEMBER 2022)a subcontracting plan with Ability One is required. How should a small business offeror address this requirement to subcontract with Ability One?	There are no mandatory contractual requirements to subcontract with AbilityOne. The Government encourages the prime contractor to provide subcontracting opportunities to AbilityOne contractors. The Government will review the Offeror's proposed plan for using AbilityOne contractors and will consider the extent to which qualified AbilityOne contractors are proposed to perform aspects of the requirement, including work associated with the functional requirements of the SOW. AbilityOne will not be scored for evaluation purposes.
56	Draft RFP, Section L.6.2.1	65	Are the Section K certifications provided in Section L.6.2.1 to be provided in Offerors' proposals along with a statement regarding SAM .GOV certs and reps compliance? Or is only the SAM.GOV certs and reps compliance required?	Offerors are not required to submit a full Section K. In lieu of Section K, Offerors shall provide the required statement IAW section L.6.2.1(d) confirming that their SAM.gov representations and certifications are current, accurate, and complete as of proposal submission. No additional certifications are required unless explicitly identified elsewhere in the solicitation.
57	Draft RFP Section I Draft J.1 IDIQ SOW Section C.3.7	Pages 35-36Page 6	The Contract contains Clause 52.227-14/Rights in Data -General and the SOW in Section C.3.7/Data Rights. Section C.3.7 seems to contradict the Data Rights and Copyrights ownership as set forth in the applicable FAR Clause. Can the Government provide clarification regarding Copyrights and Data Rights for this opportunity?	We have provided License Data Rights Options in lieu of a Copyright and therefore omitted the copyright clause from RFP and SOW.
58	Draft SOW v4, Section C.4.3.3.4	pg. 13	Why is the minimum RO SNR requirement still set at 200 V/V? The Radio Occultation Modeling Experiment (ROMEX) procured data from all available RO missions using a minimum SNR threshold of 80 V/V, and EUMETSAT operationally purchases RO data at this same threshold for dissemination to global NWP centers. Results from ROMEX and other independent studies consistently show that SNR is not a significant factor in neutral RO data quality across missions, based on metrics such as bending angle quality, penetration depth, and NWP impact (Anthes et al., 2025, and others). We therefore recommend setting the threshold to 80 V/V, as has been the accepted international scientific practice	NOAA NESDIS's minimum SNR requirements remain as written, per SOW C.4.3.3. para 4.
59	Draft SOW v4, Section C.9.3	pg. 53	What is the likely unit of measurement for neutral density observations? Number of observations? Total span of observation time per day? Will this be averaged over some time period like the RO and Ionospheric tracks?	NOAA NESDIS revised the pricing sheet to reflect "Satellites per day" as the unit solicited. Additionally, NOAA NESDIS revised Section C.9.3. of the IDIQ SOW to define minimum requirements.
60	Draft SOW v4, Section C.9.3.2.	pg. 55	Should OD-Estimated Non-Conservative Accelerations be listed as a requirement or as an optional data product? This data is not needed for all thermospheric density derivation approaches and, where required, could alternatively be derived by NOAA through orbit determination processing of dual-frequency GNSS tracking data.	NOAA NESDIS updated the Section C.9.3.2. of the IDIQ SOW to reflect the need to provide either "OD-Estimated Non-Conservative Accelerations" or "Data and metadata suitable for POD".
61	Draft RFP, Section L (Evaluation Criteria); Section M (Award Basis)	pg. 69	Will NOAA evaluate and award Functional Categories independently, or must an offeror receive a favorable rating across all proposed FCs to win any? If a company is rated highly for FC1 but marginal for FC6, can it still receive an FC1-only award?	Yes NOAA will evaluate and award Functional Categories independently.
62	Draft RFP, Section G.5 (On-Ramp Provisions)	pg. 14	For the permanent on-ramp (evaluated every 6 months), can an existing awardee add new Functional Categories it did not propose in its initial submission, or is the on-ramp limited to new entrants?	Yes, if a Contractor gains the capability to perform in a Functional Category for which they were not originally awarded, they may submit a proposal to add Functional Categories that will be evaluated based on the schedule and criteria established in this solicitation. If the Government determines the Contractor meets the technical criteria and the proposed pricing is fair and reasonable, the additional Functional Category will be incorporated into the Contractor's IDIQ contract via bilateral modification.
63	Draft RFP, Section G.6 (Interagency Use)	pg. 15	Section G.6 notes that proposal data will be shared with ICAMS members (NASA, DoD, NSF, DOE, DOI). Will these agencies issue their own Task Orders against the SBEM IDIQ, or is this sharing for awareness/coordination only? If they can issue TOs, under what authority?	This is for sharing purposes only.
64	Draft SOW v4, Section C.3.4 (Non-Duplication of Data)	pg. 5	The non-duplication clause (C.3.4) states contractors 'shall not deliver' equivalent data under SBEM if they already supply it at equal-or-better latency to entities NOAA shares with. Does this apply at the individual observation level, the product level, or the data-type level? For example, if a Contractor provides RO data to EUMETSAT under a separate commercial agreement, does that preclude a Contractor RO data from SBEM, or only the specific profiles already delivered to EUMETSAT?	This only applies to the specific data deliveries (e.g. specific RO profiles) to another entity.

65	Draft SOW v4, Section C.3.4 (Non-Duplication of Data)	pg. 5	Under C.3.4, how does NOAA define 'equivalent data'? If a Contractor delivers a different processing level (L0 vs L1), different latency tier, or different geographic subset to a third party compared to what it delivers to NOAA, would these be considered non-equivalent and thus not subject to the clause?	Section C.3.4. states that if a Contractor has an existing agreement (e.g., contract, service-level agreement, etc.) for a specific type of data with a latency that is equal or less (i.e., better) than what is required in the contract with NOAA and if the data sharing provisions of the other non-NOAA agreement allows immediate distribution to NOAA, then the Contractor shall not double-sell the same data to NESDIS CDP. If the Contractor, for example, is selling data that is a different processing level, different geospatial requirements, different observation/profile, and/or different resolution, etc, then that would not apply to this clause.
66	Draft SOW v4, Section C.3.7 (Data Rights — Copyright Assignment)	pg. 6	The copyright assignment clause states all deliverables are assigned to NOAA. Does this apply to the raw L0 observation data itself, or only to the data as formatted/packaged for delivery under the SBEM contract? Can a commercial provider continue to sell substantially the same observations to commercial customers and other governments?	We have clarified the licensing terminology in the SOW. We provide Data Licensing Options and have omitted references to ownership in the copyright clause from the RFP and SOW. Individual Task Orders under the IDIQ will indicate specific licensing for data products acquired.
67	Attachment J.2 (IDIQ Price Schedule)	pg. 52	Currently, the pricing schedule separates pricing by Functional Category, and contains detailed questions for functional category subcategories based on data license type and quantity. Will the government consider bundled options for pricing if it wants multiple products across different functional categories?	Yes, the government may consider bundled options for pricing for Task Orders, but the IDIQ pricing schedule must still be filled out accordingly as if there was nothing bundled. The vendor may attach a document describing how additional discounts can be achieved by bundling, which prices are affected, and by how much.
68	Draft SOW v4, Section C.4.4.1 (FC1 Cat 1, Enhanced Data Requirements)	pg. 17	The SOW specifies an enhanced TO option raising the SNR threshold from 200 V/V to 1200 V/V. Is this 'enhanced' option expected to be a standard element of future operational TOs, or a premium tier that NOAA will use selectively? What fraction of total purchased RO profiles does NOAA anticipate requiring at the 1200 V/V level?	NOAA NESDIS intends to use this "enhanced" option as an add-on and not a standard element of future operational TOs. NOAA NESDIS cannot speculate on percentage of total RO purchased for the higher 1200 V/V level for future TO procurements.
69	Draft SOW v4, Section C.4.2 (FC1 Cat 2 — Polarimetric RO)	pg. 10	For PRO (Polarimetric RO, Category 2), does NOAA have a target number of profiles per day, or is this capability being evaluated purely on a pilot basis with volume TBD by Task Order? What is the pathway from pilot to operational purchase of PRO?	PRO is a capability that NOAA NESDIS intends to investigate at some undetermined time in the future to assist with precipitation specification. The pathway from Pilot to Operations of PRO data will follow a similar path as RO and TEC by first Piloting with vendor(s) to thoroughly evaluate the data and also fund investments to integrate the data into the NWS operational pipeline. Once successful, and if approved, NOAA may enter into purchase agreements with vendors.
70	Draft SOW v4, Section C.6 (FC3 — Microwave Sounder, Spectral Tier Guidance)	pg. 31	The SOW describes a tiered requirement from Tier 1 (≥20 channels across 50–60 GHz + 118 GHz) down to Tier 3 (≥12 channels at 118 GHz, TROPICS-class). At what tier does NOAA expect to issue the first operational Task Orders? Will Tier 3 capability alone be sufficient for IDIQ award, or does NOAA expect a credible roadmap to higher tiers?	The tiered structure in the SOW is guidance, not a prescriptive requirement. Each parameter's tiers are independent, so Tier 3 capability alone could be sufficient for an IDIQ award. The tiers are intended to help designers prioritize features that impact global NWP performance and allow flexibility for technology maturation. Individual Task Orders will define the specific requirements for each acquisition, including which tier is expected for initial operational use, and will clarify any roadmap to higher tiers as needed.
71	Draft SOW v4, Section C.6 (FC3); NOAA 1730 Operational MW Sounder solicitation (separate)	pg. 27	There was a recent RFP for NOAA's 1730 Operational MW Sounder. How does the SBEM FC3 relate to the 1730 procurement? Are these complementary (1730 as an operational pathfinder, SBEM FC3 as the long-term data-buy vehicle), or does one supersede the other?	The OTA by the NESDIS LEO office would help accelerate technology development to meet these requirements, but that effort is seperate from NESDIS CDP. Prospective Contractors would need to go through the SBEM IDIQ award process to be awarded a commercial data buy through NESDIS CDP.
72	Draft SOW v4, Section C.9 (FC6 — Neutral Density, Satellite Physical Characteristics)	pg. 55	For the satellite physical characteristics requirement (wet/dry mass, full CAD model of outer surfaces), what level of CAD fidelity does NOAA require? Is a simplified drag-effective cross-section model acceptable, or does NOAA require full mechanical CAD including antenna assemblies, solar panels, and appendages at manufacturing tolerance?	A "simplified drag-effective cross-section model" is not ideal because the appropriateness/accuracy of a vendor's "drag-effective" calculations cannot be easily verified. However, full manufacturing tolerance is also not necessary. NOAA NESDIS updated Section C.9.3.2. of the IDIQ SOW to reflect that the required accuracy of CAD model dimensions will be defined in a per Task Order.
73	Draft SOW v4, Section C.9.5 (FC6); Section C.3.7 (Data Rights)	pg. 58	FC6 data includes orbit position and velocity information. The SOW notes NOAA may apply more restrictive data-sharing rights to orbit data. Could Data Rights Option 3 (Government + partners only) become mandatory for FC6, regardless of pricing? If so, what partners would receive the orbit data?	NOAA NESDIS will consider License Option 4, sharing with US Gov only.
74	Draft RFP, Section L.6.2 (Volume II — Technical Capability, Page Limits)	pg. 63	Could the government please increase the page count for each technical volume for functional category to a minimum of 15 pages, at least for those functional categories with multiple sub-categories?	NOAA NESDIS is limiting each technical volume to 8 pages for each functional category. Specific Task Orders will require more technical content and will have a longer maximum page count.

75	Draft SOW v4, Section C.2 (IDIQ Structure)	pg. 2	Does NOAA anticipate issuing Task Orders that span multiple Functional Categories (e.g., a combined FC1+FC6 TO for a company that delivers both RO and neutral density data from the same constellation), or will all TOs be FC-specific?	If and when appropriate, NOAA NESDIS may consider issuing task orders that are a combination of multiple functional categories.
76	Draft SOW v4, Section C.6.3.2, Table 3	pg. 31	The number 1 tier for temperature sounding suggests 20+ channels around 50–60 GHz and 118 GHz. Several studies have indicated 50–57 GHz is preferable to 118 GHz (for instance see ECMWF MW Sounder Use & Impact, Boreman, 2021), with this in mind - what is the motive for the 118 GHz channel in tier 1? Can this not be met with increased hyperspectral capability or enhanced noise figures?	Including both 50–60 GHz and 118 GHz improves temperature sounding capability, with 118 GHz providing complementary information, redundancy, and enhanced vertical resolution. While 50–57 GHz is fundamental, 118 GHz adds independent sensitivity that may not fully replaced by hyperspectral capability or improved noise performance. Keeping it in Tier 1 avoids performance degradation that would result from moving it to Tier 2. The pilot study will further assess this approach.
77	Draft SOW v4, Section C.6.3.2, Table 4	pg. 32	Hyperspectral capabilities prioritization is listed in Table 4 for K, Ka, V, W, F, D, G, and J bands. Given the difficulty of accommodating all channels on a single platform, would NOAA consider using distributed sensor data, meaning observations collected from more than one satellite and geolocated within a defined time window, to satisfy the overall requirement? Are there some channels that are preferred to be co-located and others that aren't for NOAA? What are the priorities of the suggested channels and co-registration?	The hyperspectral MWS prioritization in Table 4 is guidance to indicate potential future capability directions, including science relevant channels and extended regions for enhanced RFI detection. It is not a requirement to place all bands on a single platform. NOAA would consider distributed sensor data—multiple satellites providing observations within an acceptable time window—if the combined measurements meet microwave sounding performance needs. Some channels are preferred to be co located, especially temperature and humidity sounding channels, where co location improves vertical weighting consistency and reduces cross sensor biases. Co located similar frequency channels also provide calibration benefits.
78	Draft SOW v4, Section C.6.3.2, Table 3	pg. 31	How should suppliers consider requirements for co location or beam co registration requirement? Does NOAA have tiered requirement preference or a quantitative requirement to constrain co registration accuracy or pixel misalignment between channels?	NOAA does not define a specific co location or beam co registration requirement for the microwave sounder at this stage. In general, temperature and humidity sounding channels benefit most from being co located, since tighter alignment improves vertical weighting consistency and reduces cross sensor biases. Similar frequency channels also gain calibration advantages when co registered. NOAA does not currently specify a tiered preference or a quantitative co registration accuracy threshold. Contractors may propose co located or distributed approaches as long as the resulting system meets the NOAA needs.
79	Draft SOW v4, Section C.6.3.2, Table 3	pg. 31	Spatial resolution is typically defined separately for temperature and water vapor channels; could you please clarify whether the spatial resolution in Table 3 refers specifically to temperature sounding, water vapor sounding, or both?	The spatial resolution is intended as a general reference across the instrument. It is not specific to either temperature or water vapor sounding, as resolution can vary by channel. Vendors should interpret this as representative of overall system performance, with channel-dependent variation expected.
80	Draft RFP, Section M (Award Basis); Section L.6.2.1	pg. 65	How many IDIQ awards does NOAA anticipate making per Functional Category, and is there a target or cap? Will all technically acceptable offerors receive awards, or is NOAA limiting the competitive set for future Task Orders?	There is no cap on the number of awards. See section M of the solicitation for basis for award.
81	Draft RFP, Section L.6 (Proposal Instructions); Section M	pg. 65	The RFP indicates proposals must be valid for 180+ calendar days and the Government intends to award without discussions. If NOAA identifies minor clarification items, will there be an opportunity for Exchanges, or are initial proposals truly best-and-final?	It is requested that Offerors provide their best and final proposal at time of initial submission due date. Discussions may be used if its in the best interest of the Government.
82	Draft SOW v4, Section C.5 (FC2 — GNSS-R, QC Flag Definitions)	pg. 23	The compliant track definition references QC flags (SNR threshold, geometric validity, antenna gain, track continuity) but states exact definitions will be set per Task Order. Will NOAA provide reference QC definitions during the IDIQ evaluation, or is compliance demonstrated only at the TO level?	The SBEM IDIQ is intended to establish the broad contractual framework for a wide array of data capabilities, while individual Task Orders will define the specific data sets, processing levels, and QC required for particular missions. NOAA NESDIS will provide detailed QC and compliance definitions and requirements at the Task Order level. At the IDIQ level, Offerors should describe their QC process as part of their overall product description.
83	Draft SOW v4, Section C.6.3.2, Table 4	pg. 32	For the temporal refresh requirements are stated for Hyperspectral MW Sounder capabilities, how are NOAA considering suppliers assess adherence to this requirement? For instance, should this be viewed alongside existing operational sounders, including commercial providers, or just government owned backbone sounders?	Compliance can consider government, international partners, and commercial providers, as long as the combined system meets operational coverage, latency, and data quality objectives.
84	Draft SOW v4, Section C.6 (FC3 — Microwave Sounder, RFI Detection)	pg. 30	For the RFI detection requirement (baseline for V, W, Ka, K bands), does NOAA expect on-board real-time RFI flagging, or is ground-based post-processing detection acceptable? What is the expected false-flag tolerance?	We do not specify numeric thresholds for RFI detection, but we expect it to be addressed through detection algorithms, mitigation techniques, and instrument-level strategies—either in combination or individually—to ensure the data meet NOAA's requirements.

85	Draft SOW v4, Section C.9.3.2 (FC6 — Neutral Density, Spatial Requirements)	pg. 54	Does NOAA have a minimum altitude range or orbit diversity requirement for FC6?	NOAA NESDIS specified an altitude range of 180 to 800 km in Section 9.3. of the IDIQ SOW.
86	Draft SOW v4, Section C.3.4 (General Requirements — Operational Support, 24×7 POC)	pg. 5	The 24×7 POC with 60-minute response SLA applies to operational TOs. If a contractor holds awards across multiple Functional Categories, is a single operations center and POC acceptable, or does NOAA require independent 24×7 support per FC?	NOAA NESDIS is agnostic to either approach.
87	Draft SOW v4, Section C.3.6 (Security Requirements)	pg. 6	The security requirements reference both NIST SP 800-53 and ISO 27001/27002. If a Contractor holds ISO 27001 certification, is that accepted with a gap analysis against NIST 800-53 high-impact baseline, or must NIST 800-53 compliance be demonstrated independently?	Compliance with NIST 800-53 is mandatory. ISO 27001 certification can be mapped to NIST 800-53 but it is not as comprehensive as NIST's framework. A gap analysis with an ISO 27001 certification is not acceptable.
88	Draft SOW v4, Section C.3.3 (Notification Requirements)	pg. 4	The notification requirement (quarterly health/status reports and 12-month constellation forecasts) persists even without an active Task Order. Does NOAA reimburse the cost of ongoing reporting during periods between TOs, or is this considered part of the IDIQ overhead with no direct compensation?	This requirement is only for Contractors with Operational Task Orders.
89	Draft RFP, Section L.6.2 (Volume II Instructions); Section M (Evaluation Criteria)	pg. 63	The draft states that 'paraphrasing the SOW is considered inadequate.' Can NOAA provide positive examples or further guidance on what evaluators consider a strong demonstration of technical capability within the 8-page constraint? Should the focus be on past performance/delivery metrics, or on technical approach to meeting requirements?	Contractors shall adequately demonstrate how they will meet data requirements. This may include, for example, past delivery metrics, technical approach, etc.
90	NESDIS Industry Day announcement (March 19, 2026); Draft SOW v4, Section C.11 (FC8 — Additional SBEM)	pg. 65	The Industry Day announcement mentions 'wildfire imagery' data pilots. Is this a signal that FC4 (VIS/IR) or FC8 (Additional SBEM) Task Orders may include wildfire detection as a priority application? Would NOAA be interested in wildfire-related data products from non-traditional sensors?	Offerors are invited to attend the Industry Day, which serves as a forum to discuss NOAA NESDIS CDP's upcoming activities and priorities including wildfire detection. NOAA would be interested in data products from non-traditional sensors; however, data provided must originate from the Offeror's on-orbit sensors.
91	Draft SOW v4, Section C.6.3.2, Table 4	pg. 32	Is there a preferred tiering system for lifetime of the mission, for instance longer lifetime satellite versus regular replenishment of satellites for continuity?	NOAA NESDIS modified the SOW to strike "lifetime" of the mission, but rather focus on the Period of Performance for the data contracted (type, amount).
92	Draft SOW v4, C.5.3.2 GNSS-R Data Requirements. C.5.3.2.1.a.i	pg. 26	Compressed DDMs (with a reduced range of delay and Doppler) are downlinked to reduce the data volume compared to Full-resolution DDMs. Is it the intent that both (i) Full resolution and (ii) Compressed DDMs are both required, or are compressed DDMs as per the pilot acceptable?	The SBEM IDIQ is intended to establish the broad contractual framework for a wide array of applications, and as such includes the possibility for acquisition of uncompressed or compressed DDMs. The IDIQ SOW has been revised to clarify this. Individual Task Orders will specify whether compressed or uncompressed DDMs are required. Offerors are invited to give feedback on the limitations versus benefits of compressed DDMs during the draft RFP commenting process for Task Orders.
93	Draft SOW v4, C.5.3.2 GNSS-R Data Requirements C.5.3.2.1.c.ii	pg. 23 and 27	The government requests that, as part of GNSS-R Data Requirements, that. a contractor should "Provide all data used for calibration/validation and product development." Given that GNSS-R product development and Level 2 ocean wind calibration is carried out with large historical datasets (e.g. 12 months) to observe extreme wind conditions, can this requirement be clarified to the Level 1 calibration?	The SBEM IDIQ is intended to establish the broad contractual framework for a wide array of applications, and as such includes the possibility for acquisition of both uncompressed and compressed DDMs. Individual Task Orders will specify whether compressed or uncompressed DDMs are required. Offerors are invited to give feedback on the limitations versus benefits of compressed DDMs during the draft RFP commenting process for Task Orders.
94	Draft SOW v4, C.5.4 Observation Requirements C.5.4.2.c.i	pg. 28	The government requests that Quality Control for GNSS-R include "The peak of the Delay-Doppler Map (DDM) must be sufficiently above the noise floor. For example, a SNR of < 2dB may be considered not compliant." What is the definition of this, SNR? There two standard definitions, biased SNR=(S/N) and unbiased SNR=(S/N - 1), both measures are commonly used in GNSS-R. Due to the use of non-coherent averaging, typical SNR noise floor values are SNR_unbiased > -8 dB and SNR_biased > 0.6 dB. Selection of this value is important as an SNR requirement set too high would exclude high-wind events, or those near the edges of the field of view."	NOAA agrees that the definition of SNR and appropriate minimum values should be clarified in Task Orders in order to avoid excluding high wind events or events near field of view limits. The SOW has been modified to clarify that specific SNR definitions and requirements will be defined in individual Task Orders. This is a good topic for further conversation and Offerors are invited to give feedback on appropriate SNR definitions and requirements during the draft RFP commenting process for Task Orders.

95	Draft SOW v4, C.5.5 Delivery Requirements C.5.5.1.b	pg. 29	In previous GNSS-R pilot studies, the data was split into ocean and land streams. The ice data was aggregated with the land data. Is there intention to have 3 separate streams?	GNSS-R data flagging and/or splitting requirements will be clarified in future Task Orders. The requirements for each Task Order will be designed to support optimal data processing and production of specific GNSS-R products.
96	Draft RFP, Section L.4 and L.4.1, Proposal Schedule	pg. 62	When will contractors receive the answers to the final RFP questions currently due on May 8? Would the government please allow no later than 3 weeks post answers to questions on the Final RFP to prepare their final responses in accordance with the answers to questions as any answers to questions could impact multiple areas of a proposal?	NOAA intends to provide answers to the final RFP questions as soon as practical.
97	J.1 SOW	6	The mandatory copyright assignment in SOW C.3.7(2) is unnecessary, overbroad, and misaligned with the commercial nature of this procurement and should be removed. Its inclusion appears to stem from the use of CAR 1352.227-70 and FAR 52.227-17 (Special Works), which, as discussed in our comments to Draft RFP with respect to inclusion of CAR 1352.227-70, are not appropriate for this acquisition. As a result, the copyright assignment requirement is not warranted. This procurement involves commercially produced satellite data generated from privately developed and funded systems—not "special works" created solely for Government ownership. Requiring assignment of "all deliverables", including the processed data and related documentation, would impair contractor's ability to provide similar products commercially. This is inconsistent with the FAR's framework for commercial and non-developmental procurements. The clause is overly broad because it does not distinguish between data first produced in performance and preexisting or privately developed data. This conflicts with FAR 52.227-14, which appropriately preserves contractor ownership of preexisting intellectual property while granting the Government broad license rights. Under that clause, the Government already receives "unlimited rights" in data first produced in performance, including the ability to use, reproduce, distribute, and create derivative works. SOW C.3.7(1) already provides NOAA with a broad, perpetual license to use and disseminate the data and authorize others to do so. Additionally, the various license options 1-3A provide the government and its contractors sufficient rights to fully utilize the data for government purposes. Many supporting data requests (such as, but not limited to, antenna patterns and ATBDs) represent highly competitive technical information that must not be publicly released or reproduced. Data and documentation procured under this IDIQ was produced entirely at private expense and should be treated as limited rights data as defined in 48 CFR 52.227-14. Please remove the copyright assignment paragraph in its entirety.	Removed CAR 1352.227-70, FAR 52.227-17, and copyright assignment paragraph in the SOW.
98	J.1 SOW	11	C.4.3.1 definition 7. Please define the time of an ionospheric track to correspond to the 120 km HSL altitude point. This improves consistency with definition 10 for geographic location.	NOAA NESDIS updated the SBEM IDIQ SOW to reflect this change.
99	J.1 SOW	13	C.4.3.3 requirement 1: Please revise to "50 Hz, 100 Hz, or higher". 125 Hz data is successfully utilized operationally today, and both 200 Hz and 250 Hz data are being operationally acquired by instruments today.	NOAA NESDIS updated the SBEM IDIQ SOW to reflect this change.
100	J.1 SOW	13	C.4.3.3 requirement 6: Please add QZSS and dual-frequency SBAS to the list of acceptable GNSS satellites for RO soundings.	NOAA NESDIS may consider QZSS and other navigation satellite systems in future Task Orders.
101	J.1 SOW	14	C.4.3.3 requirement 19: Please stipulate that the daily count of RO soundings should be averaged over continuous 30 day periods rather than 15-day periods.	NOAA NESDIS modified the SOW to reflect 30 days, not 15.
102	J.1 SOW	15	C.4.3.4 requirement 5: This requirement cites a definition that does not exist in the SOW.	Citing deleted.
103	J.1 SOW	16	C.4.3.5.1 requirement 10: Please harmonize this requirement with C.4.3.3 requirement 19.	NOAA NESDIS understands and harmonized the continuous 30-day requirement with both RO and TEC deliveries.
104	J.1 SOW	16	C.4.3.5.2 requirement 4: Please revise to "10 seconds or less"	NOAA NESDIS updated the SBEM IDIQ SOW to reflect this change.
105	J.1 SOW	23	C.5.4 requirements 1 & 2: Please provide typical and maximally-stringent values that an individual task order SOW may stipulate over the course of the IDIQ.	The Threshold requirements provided represent typical values for a Task Order SOW. 'Maximally stringent' values are more appropriately defined in specific Task Orders and will be determined through coordinated research conducted by NESDIS STAR, NWS, other research partners, and Offerors.
106	J.1 SOW	25	C.5.5 requirement 4: Please add QZSS and SBAS to the list of acceptable GNSS satellites for GNSS-R observations.	The list of acceptable GNSS satellites will be specified in each Task Order. Offerors are invited to give feedback on the benefits of including specific GNSS satellites during the draft RFP commenting process for Task Orders.
107	J.1 SOW	30	C.6.3.2 requirement 4 Table 2 appears to use a mixture of pre-1978 NATO, post-1978 NATO, and IEEE nomenclature for lettered band identifiers. To reduce ambiguity, please use numerical frequency ranges in every row of this table.	Revised Table 2 to replace the lettered band identifiers with numerical frequency ranges
108	Draft RFP - Section H.5 SECTION H CLAUSES INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE	18	CAR 1352.227-70 (Rights in Data, Assignment of Copyright) should be removed since FAR 52.227-17 (Special Works) Is not appropriate for this procurement. Because this acquisition is for commercially produced satellite-based weather data, not a contract primarily for the production or compilation of data for the Government's own use within the meaning of FAR 27.405-1, FAR 52.227-17 and CAR 1352.227-70 are not appropriate. NOAA's legitimate mission needs should already be satisfied by the broad license rights already set forth in SOW C.3.7(1) and by FAR 52.227-14, which grants the Government unlimited rights in data first produced in performance while preserving the contractor's ownership of its underlying commercial intellectual property and permitting appropriate licensing of any pre existing materials incorporated into deliverables.	Removed CAR 1352.227-70, FAR 52.227-17, and copyright assignment paragraph in the SOW.
109	J.1 SOW	25	C.5.4 How long (in surface km? minutes?) should a GNSS-R track be to be considered salable as a single "track" in accordance with the pricing schedule?	The requirements for minimal track length will be defined in specific Task Orders. This is a good topic for further conversation especially with consideration of how Offeror sensors are designed and operated. Offerors are invited to give feedback on track definitions and requirements during the draft RFP commenting process for Task Orders.
110	J.1 SOW	27-32	C.6.2, C.6.3.2 In order to meet NOAA's Hyperspectral microwave capabilities, can we simply add additional analog filtered channels or does NOAA want a system with digitally sampled spectrum several GHz wide which is then digitally processed into channels?	NOAA's focus is on achieving the hyperspectral MW sounder performance requirements, not prescribing hardware. Vendors may use additional analog channels or a digitally sampled spectrum, as long as the system meets the requirements.
111	J.1 SOW	31	Table 3. In the temperature row under Tier 3 (baseline), we note that while TROPICS has 12 channels total, only 7 of those are sampling the 118 GHz O2 line for deriving temperature profiles. Please consider revising this baseline O2 line temperature sounding requirement to 7 channels.	Updated to 7 channels around the 118 GHz O line.
112	J.1 SOW	20, 27, 36, 45	The word, "scalable", is used in Sections C.5.1, C.6.2, C.7.2 and C.8.2. Could NOAA please provide some additional clarification on what they mean in using this word?	Purchasing data affords NOAA with scalable access to commercial data. In other words, it allows NOAA the ability to use the data in a range of capabilities.

113	SBEM IDIQ SOW J.1 – Commercial Environmental Data Scope	2	Does NOAA intend SBEM to procure raw environmental data streams only, or to include operational environmental intelligence services (e.g., fused, processed, or nowcasted outputs) that directly support mission decision-making?	NOAA NESDIS CDP intends to procure raw environmental data that must originate from the Contractor's on-orbit instrument. NOAA NESDIS CDP is not considering procuring value-added environmental intelligence products or services at this time.
114	SBEM IDIQ SOW J.1 – Derived Data Products	2	To what extent will NOAA prioritize or evaluate higher-level, value-added products (e.g., fused datasets, physics-informed analytics, nowcasts) versus raw observational data streams?	NOAA NESDIS CDP intends to procure raw environmental data that must originate from the Contractor's on-orbit instrument. NOAA NESDIS CDP is not considering procuring value-added environmental intelligence products or services at this time.
115	SBEM IDIQ SOW J.1 – Forecasting, Modeling, Monitoring	2	Can vendors propose capabilities that transform multi-source environmental data into real-time or predictive outputs (e.g., nowcasting, forecasting, model-based inference), and will these be evaluated as primary deliverables rather than ancillary services?	NOAA NESDIS CDP intends to procure raw environmental data that must originate from the Contractor's on-orbit instrument. NOAA NESDIS CDP is not considering procuring value-added environmental intelligence products or services at this time.
116	SBEM IDIQ SOW J.1 – Environmental Data Categories	2	Is space weather and ionospheric monitoring considered an eligible environmental category under SBEM, particularly where it supports RF propagation, tracking, and space domain awareness missions?	Functional Category 1 (GNSS-RO) contains requirements for sensing ionospheric parameters (specific to Total Electron Content and Scintillation). Functional Category 6 (Thermospheric Neutral Density) measures the density of the non-ionized thermosphere. These capabilities support civil and military Space Domain Awareness missions. NOAA NESDIS is not soliciting for any other parameters directly or indirectly measuring other properties of the ionosphere, neutral atmosphere above 100 km in altitude, or other space weather capabilities at this time.
117	SBEM IDIQ SOW – Derived Environmental Products	3	Will NOAA accept and evaluate derived environmental intelligence products (e.g., processed, fused, or modeled outputs) in lieu of, or alongside, raw data feeds? If so, how will these be assessed relative to raw data submissions?	The Contractor must operate a sensor on-orbit that meets the requirements to deliver lower instrument-level (L0/L1) data to NOAA.
118	SBEM IDIQ SOW J.1 – Data Integration & Interfaces	2	Will SBEM support delivery models where capabilities are provided as API-enabled services or software platforms (e.g., environmental intelligence layers) rather than discrete data products?	NOAA NESDIS desires discrete data products.
119	SBEM IDIQ SOW J.1 – Multi-Provider Integration	2	Will SBEM support delivery models where capabilities are provided as API-enabled services or software platforms (e.g., environmental intelligence layers) rather than discrete data products?	NOAA NESDIS desires discrete data products.
120	SBEM IDIQ SOW J.1 – Operational Data Delivery & Latency	4,6	Can a single vendor provide a fused environmental intelligence capability that integrates multiple third-party data sources, and how will NOAA address data provenance, attribution, and pricing in such cases?	The Contractor must operate a sensor on-orbit that meets the requirements to deliver data in one or more Functional Categories.
121	SBEM IDIQ – Contract Structure (Small Business Participation)	TBD (Section L/M or IDIQ structure)	Will SBEM include small business set-asides, reserves, or on-ramp provisions, and how will task orders be allocated between large and small business awardees?	Refer to G.3.1 of the solicitation.
122	SBEM IDIQ – Teaming & Participation Model	TBD	Can small businesses serve as prime contractors for analytic or software-based capabilities, or will participation primarily be structured through subcontracting to larger data providers?	The Contractor must operate a sensor on-orbit that meets the requirements to deliver data in one or more Functional Categories. A Prime contractor may choose to partner with another entity to help meet the requirements.
123	SBEM IDIQ – Evaluation Criteria (Section M)	TBD	How will NOAA ensure evaluation criteria do not unintentionally favor high-volume raw data providers over vendors delivering higher-value analytic, fused, or derived environmental intelligence products?	The Contractor must operate a sensor on-orbit that meets the requirements to deliver data in one or more Functional Categories.
124	SBEM IDIQ SOW J.1 – Data Ingestion & Standards	2,4	Are there defined standards or expectations for metadata, formatting, and interoperability for derived or fused products, particularly those delivered via APIs or software services?	The Contractor must operate a sensor on-orbit that meets the requirements to deliver data in one or more Functional Categories.
125	Section B.4	5	Does NOAA have a projected timeline or roadmap for issuing task orders under each Functional Category?	We currently do not. The amount of Task Orders is based on our annual budget.
126	Section C.8.3.2 Table 3b	49	Spatial Resolution in row 1 should be "Spectral Resolution."	NOAA NESDIS corrected this spelling error.
127	Section C.6.3.2 Table 3	31	For Functional Categories (FC) requiring significant capital investment (e.g., Tier 1 hyperspectral MW sounders), can NOAA provide an estimated annual data volumes or coverage requirements it anticipates procuring, or a budget allocation of funding availability for each FC during the base period? This information would help offerors assess market viability and make risk-informed decisions about infrastructure investments.	We cannot provide estimated budget allocations for each Functional Category at this time.
128	Section L.6.2.2(b)(4)	66	For offerors proposing under "Planned Mission" criteria with significant capital requirements, will NOAA consider issuing Letters of Intent or advance procurement commitments to support infrastructure development? The current IDIQ structure provides no guaranteed revenue creating significant financial risk for offerors making substantial capital investments in anticipation of future task orders.	The Government cannot provide advanced procurement commitments.

129	Section 52.212-4	27	Does the Government consider on-orbit anomalies (satellite failures, space weather events, debris strikes, etc.) to qualify as "excusable delays" under FAR 52.212-4(f)?	NOAA NESDIS understands unforeseen events can occur. If such an unfortunate event occurs, the Contractor would not be subject to default; however, NOAA NESDIS will only pay for data that is delivered per the requirements in the SBEM IDIQ SOW.
130	Section 52.212-4	27	How do excusable delay provisions interact with the performance thresholds specified in the SOW (e.g., the 80% delivery requirement)?	NOAA NESDIS understands unforeseen events can occur. If such an unfortunate event occurs, the Contractor would not be subject to default; however, NOAA NESDIS will only pay for data that is delivered per the requirements in the SBEM IDIQ SOW.
131	Section 52.212-4	27	Are there specific provisions or expectations regarding payment, performance requirements, and potential penalties during periods when data delivery is interrupted due to on-orbit anomalies?	NOAA NESDIS understands unforeseen events can occur. If such an unfortunate event occurs, the Contractor would not be subject to default; however, NOAA NESDIS will only pay for data that is delivered per the requirements in the SBEM IDIQ SOW.
132	Section 52.212-4	27	Would the Government consider adding explicit language addressing space-specific force majeure events?	NOAA NESDIS understands unforeseen events can occur. If such an unfortunate event occurs, the Contractor would not be subject to default; however, NOAA NESDIS will only pay for data that is delivered per the requirements in the SBEM IDIQ SOW.
133	N/A		Does the Government anticipate including any performance incentives, award fees, or bonus payment structures in individual Task Orders for contractors who consistently exceed minimum performance requirements? If not, how does the Government intend to incentivize superior performance beyond minimum contractual obligations?	TBD on a task order basis.
134	N/A		What is the anticipated range of task order durations (minimum and maximum) for both Pilot and Operational Deliveries? Are there different duration expectations for different Functional Categories? Will task orders typically be structured as short-term pilots followed by longer-term operational contracts, or does the Government anticipate issuing long-duration operational task orders from the outset? This is particularly important for business planning and investment decisions.	NOAA NESDIS does not have a predicted range of Period of Performances; however, in general, Pilot Task Orders are shorter in length than Operational Task Orders. While NOAA can't specify a length for any Operational Task Order, it is the intent to issue Task Orders for no less than 12-months in duration.
135	Sections L/M		Will there be a non-binding forecast of order level requirements (derived from total contract ceiling value) published for industry awareness and planning purpose?	We do not currently have this projection.
136	Sections L/M		Is there a Total Evaluated Price (TEP) projected for evaluation and will industry have flexibility to propose different quantity breaks for pricing purpose in the schedule?	Yes. On the Instructions tab on the Price Schedule, which states "The TEP is essentially the sum of the Extended Scenario Prices for 365 days per Functional Category, and per Subcategory when applicable. The TEP is for evaluation purposes only and does not reflect award value." The vendor may attach a document describing how additional discounts/breaks can be achieved, which prices are affected, and by how much.
137	Section C.3.6		If an Offeror were to be awarded a task order based upon a credible plan and commitment to acquiring on-orbit capability, would that award then be accompanied by Government oversight during the development of the on-orbit asset to ensure the eventual data meets the objectives?	NOAA NESDIS may award an IDIQ contract to a Vendor with a credible plan to launch and operate a sensor on-orbit that meets the requirements in one or more of the Functional Categories. To earn a Task Order award within the IDIQ, the Vendor must meet those specific requirements. NOAA NESDIS will not provide oversight during the development of the on-orbit asset.
138	Section G.5	14	Although G.5 does state that the Government reserves the right to adjust evaluation frequency based on the volume of submissions or agency needs, would the Government consider lowering the evaluation period from every six (6) months to every three (3) months?	The Government reserves the right to award additional contracts if it is determined to be in its best interest. This solicitation will remain open for the duration of the base period and any exercised option periods. Proposals may be submitted at any time and the Government will evaluate them at a set cadence.
139	Section C.8.3.2		Item (10) states that "Contractors shall provide, at a minimum, IR Radiance observations that satisfy capabilities within one or more the spectral ranges in Table 2." Does the term "within" indicate that providing radiances measurements in a portion of one or more of these bands is acceptable, or do the measurements need to cover the entirety of one or more of the stated spectral ranges? For example, do radiance measurements in the SWIR band need to cover the entire region of 1.5-4.8 um, or is a portion of this region acceptable?	The term “within” in the SOW is intended as guidance rather than a strict requirement. Radiance measurements do not need to cover the entire stated spectral range; coverage of a portion of the specified band that supports the mission objectives is acceptable. The guidance is meant to help vendors understand the spectral regions of interest while allowing flexibility in sensor design to achieve the required performance.
140	Section L.6.2.2	65	Section L.6.2.2 states "Each proposed Functional Category must be presented in its own dedicated section within the volume" and "Contractors are only eligible to compete for Task Orders issued under the specific Functional Categories for which they were evaluated (technical and price) and granted an award at the IDIQ level." If an offeror proposes capabilities across multiple Functional Categories that are technically integrated to provide enhanced value when procured together, how should this integrated value proposition be presented? Should it be described in each separate Functional Category section, or is there a mechanism to present the combined technical advantages?	The Contractor shall submit a separate Technical Volume for capabilities within each Functional Category they choose to propose to. If a requirement in one functional category ties to another functional category, the Vendor may choose to reference the other technical volume in its proposal.
141	Section B.4	5	Section B.4 states "Competition at the task order level is expected to establish fair and reasonable pricing for task orders." Will NOAA consider issuing Task Orders that combine multiple Functional Categories to enable offerors to propose integrated pricing that reflects the cost efficiencies and enhanced value of co-located observations?	If and when appropriate, NOAA may consider issuing task orders that cross into multiple functional categories.
142	Section C.2	1	Section C.2 states "NOAA is mostly interested in raw instrument data; however, NOAA may seek value-added or derived products to meet mission objectives." If an integrated constellation can provide value-added products that leverage the synergy of co-located observations, how should these capabilities be described in the Technical Capability volume?	This is possible; however, the data must originate from a sensor that the Contractor operates. The Contractor shall describe the technical nature of how they would meet the requirements in their proposal.
143	Section C.2	1	Section C.2 states "This IDIQ describes broader, less restrictive requirements, while Individual Task Orders within the IDIQ will stipulate more restrictive/refined/narrower requirements." If a contractor demonstrates capability at IDIQ award that significantly exceeds the threshold requirements in a Functional Category (e.g., spatial resolution, temporal refresh, spectral coverage, or latency that is 2-5x better than the threshold), can NOAA issue Task Orders that require this enhanced level of performance, even if only one or a subset of IDIQ holders can meet the enhanced requirement?	NOAA NESDIS may issue Task Orders that exceed the requirements listed in the IDIQ SOW.
144	Section G.3.1	14	Section G.3.1 states "All ProTech-SBEM contract holders with the relevant Functional Categories awarded on their IDIQ contracts will be provided a fair opportunity to be considered on task orders, in accordance with FAR 16.507-2." How does NOAA interpret "fair opportunity" when Task Order requirements exceed the IDIQ threshold requirements? Does "fair opportunity" mean all IDIQ holders in a Functional Category must be capable of meeting the Task Order requirements, or does it mean all IDIQ holders are invited to propose even if their demonstrated IDIQ capabilities don't meet the enhanced Task Order requirements?	Task orders (TOs) will be awarded on a functional category basis. Contractors are only eligible to compete for TOs issued under the specific Functional Categories for which they were evaluated (technical and price) and granted an award at the IDIQ level. NOAA NESDIS will issue an RFP for each TO specifying the requirements that are needed for that effort. All IDIQ Contract holders of the Functional Category for which the TO applies to are welcome to propose to such a TO.

145	Section G.3.1	14	Section G.3.1 states that fair opportunity will be provided "unless exempted in accordance with applicable terms of the FAR." Under what circumstances can NOAA issue Task Orders with specialized or enhanced requirements that may only be met by either one or a subset of IDIQ holders? What FAR exceptions to fair opportunity would apply in these scenarios (e.g., FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(B) - only one contractor capable of providing at the required level of quality)?	Refer to FAR 16.507-6(b)
146	Section G.5	14	Section G.5 states "The Government intends to evaluate new proposals every six (6) months from the date of initial contract award" and "Proposals must follow the same format and satisfy the same technical requirements as specified in Section L of the initial solicitation." If a contractor on-ramps with capabilities that significantly exceed the IDIQ threshold requirements (e.g., a next-generation sensor with 5x better resolution or refresh rate), will NOAA update the performance standards or "objective" requirements in the SOW for future Task Orders to reflect state-of-the-art capabilities? Can NOAA issue Task Orders that require the enhanced performance level demonstrated by the on-ramped contractor? How will NOAA balance fair opportunity for existing IDIQ holders against the Government's interest in leveraging superior capabilities from newly on-ramped contractors?	SBEM IDIQ requirements are generally written in broader nature than Task Orders. NOAA NESDIS may issue Task Orders that exceed the requirements listed in the IDIQ SOW. NOAA NESDIS will write the Task Order requirements based on NOAA operational needs at that time.
147	Sections L/M	71	Can the Government provide an estimated number of Small Business set-aside orders are projected and/or which functional categories?	No.
148	Sections L/M		Does the Government anticipate mandating order level proposals for every order RFP issued for competition within a functional category or otherwise industry determined?	TBD on a task order basis.
149	C.6.3.2 Table	31	NEDT values for temperature and moisture sounding are defined in absolute terms relative to ATMS. ATMS NEDT vary by channel, typically between 0.6 to 2.4K. NEDT measurements can be readily targeted by modifying integration time and bandwidth at the cost of other, less clearly-defined performance specs, and reduces the feasibility of narrow-bandwidth channels which have wide use for stratospheric sounding. Recommend re-stating NEdT requirements in terms of K root(MHz msec), which more accurately represents the system noise temperature without biasing vendors away from higher atmospheric sounding channels	The requirement refers to the ATMS equivalent noise/NEDT, which accounts for integration time and bandwidth. Expressing NEDT this way avoids relying on fixed absolute ATMS values and provides a more accurate, bandwidth neutral measure of system noise performance.
150		31	Calibration is poorly-defined. Relative to what background and using which model? Is this a NOAA-calculated variable?	Table 3 is intended as guidance for hyperspectral MW sounder capabilities, not a NOAA calculated calibration variable.
151		31	L1C data is defined as gridded on e.g. EASE grid. This designation is typically used for an inter calibrated dataset on a swath geometry - should this gridded data be inter-calibrated? Does the government want to see inter-calibration amongst similar on-orbit assets? What intercalibration references would the government want to see for novel channel sets?	"'L1C' is used here simply to indicate a gridded product for downstream applications, not an inter calibrated dataset. If inter calibration among on orbit assets or references for novel channel sets is intended, that requirement would belong at the L1B level.
152			What will be NOAA's procedure for onboarding other types of data as they become commercially viable such as microwave imagery or microwave limb sounding?	NOAA will generate Level 2+ Imagery from Microwave Sounder data for mainly tropical prediction use. Microwave Imagers, however, are not covered by any specific functional category. NOAA may consider additional capabilities, such as Microwave Imagers, at a future time via the Additional SBEM Requirements category.
153			Is NOAA interested in only l1 calibrated data or are vendors encouraged to also supply value added products/services such as level 2 and level 3 data, data assimilation, and numerical prediction capabilities?	NOAA NESDIS is primarily interested in all levels of data that will be specified in the Task Orders.
154		30 p4	Limiting spectral collections only to EESS allocations limits numerous potentially valuable data collections arbitrarily. If systems are able to produce impactful measurements in non-allocated, or RFI contaminated bands, they should not automatically be disqualified from use. Even current government operational systems are operating in non allocated or shared allocation spectral bands	The SOW is not limiting spectral collections to EESS allocated bands—these are provided as guidance on preferred operating regions to support consistent NOAA data record considerations, not to exclude useful measurements outside EESS allocations. Several current operational systems already use non allocated or shared bands, so high value measurements in those regions should remain in scope.
155		30 t2	There are numerous spectral features from 300 GHz up to 900 GHz that could be useful for remote sensing and are already being operationalized on other missions such as the 325 GHz water vapour band or 680 GHz cloud ice imaging band - this table should be expanded to allow for any spectral bands to be observed that could benefit NWP, or environmental product generation. The use of the 380 and 556 GHz bands for humidity gives the potential for a full column water vapour measurement that could be very beneficial for upper atmospheric modeling as another example. Table 3 also includes potential channels above J band	The value of spectral features above 300 GHz is well recognized, and nothing in the document is intended to exclude those bands. The table is meant to provide guidance, not to limit future capabilities. In fact, Table 3 already includes channels above J band, reflecting openness to higher frequency options. If additional bands (e.g., 325, 380, 556, 680 GHz) can demonstrably benefit NWP or environmental products, they should remain in scope for the IDIQ.
156		32	It is stated that "Particular attention should also be paid to the striping effect, which should be minimized as much as possible (or eliminated) when designing the sensor." Will NOAA place requirements on striping noise? If a vendor is able to deliver data with reduced striping, will that data be eligible for a higher pricing tier?	Striping is a known issue in MWS type data, and it can negatively affect data assimilation quality. The statement in the document is intended as guidance to ensure sensors are well-calibrated so that their data can be smoothly integrated into NOAA's models, not to imply pricing implications or establish a requirement. NOAA may define quantitative striping limits in the Task Orders.
157		34 p2/3	75% minimum operational availability seems to conflict w/ the continuous/contiguous NRT data delivery requirement. It would be helpful to understand which should take priority or be seen as the higher value requirement to meet	requirement to 70% min data availability (ref para 2); although NOAA NESDIS may issue Task Orders with higher data availability thresholds. 70% represents a measurable metric for compliance. Para 3 discusses that the Contractor "must have the capability to provide continuous and contiguous data long-track for one satellite". Having the "capability" is separate from "data availability."